RECOVERY 10

Thymosin alpha-1

Synthetic 28-amino-acid peptide, same structure as natural thymosin alpha-1 from thymus tissue



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Peptide	Hepatitis B, sepsis, immune response	Phase 3 trials; approved in Italy	Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

- **Sepsis** — HUMAN
- **Hepatitis B** — HUMAN
- **Flu vaccine add-on** — HUMAN
- **COVID-19 on dialysis** — HUMAN

No muscle or injury trials. It is an immune drug. No trial has tested it for muscle or injury recovery.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Thymosin alpha-1 ▶ Lymphocytes ▶ Immune signaling ▶ Immune response

- **Acts on immune cells,** especially lymphocytes, per the Italian label
- Classed as an **immunostimulant** (thymic hormone, immunomodulator)
- **Not a muscle or tissue-repair drug** in its approved use

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Sepsis trial, 1,106 people: no effect on death rates
- US hepatitis B Phase 3: benefit not confirmed
- No trials for muscle or injury recovery

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Half-life in people
- Effects on sperm in men
- Use for injury recovery
- Compounded product quality

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	Injection under the skin
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Peak about 6 hours after injection; baseline within 24 hours	Prescription injection in Italy (Zadaxin); not approved in the US
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
28-day deaths, hepatitis B virus markers, liver enzymes	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; Category 2 nomination withdrawn
HHS	Not in the Oct 2026 peptide compounding policy
AIFA	Approved in Italy (Zadaxin), 1996
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. AIFA, Zadaxin summary of product characteristics, Feb 2026
2. Wu J, et al., BMJ, TESTS sepsis trial, Jan 2025
3. FDA, bulk drug substances with significant safety risks (Category 2), Apr 2026

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